Class 11th English Writing Skills: Complete Compendium

Syllabus: JKBOSE & CBSE Board Examination Standards | Section B: Advanced Writing Skills

Prescribed Curriculum: **Core General English (Class XI)** • 100% Comprehensive Coverage

SECTION B: WRITING SKILLS SYLLABUS OVERVIEW

The Writing Section of Class 11th General English evaluates the student's ability to communicate clearly, logically, and persuasively using standard grammatical structures and prescribed board formats. Below is the blueprint of writing tasks:

Category	Writing Tasks Included	Word Limit	Marks
Short Writing Tasks	Notice Writing, Classified Advertisements, Poster Making	50 words	3 – 4 Marks
Formal Letter Writing	Letter to the Editor, Official Complaints, Business Enquiries, Job Application with Bio-Data / Resume	120 – 150 words	5 Marks
Long Composition Tasks	Article Writing, Speech Writing, Debate Writing, School Magazine / Newspaper Report Writing	150 – 200 words	5 – 6 Marks

1. Notice Writing (Short Writing Task)

A **Notice** is a formal printed or written announcement meant to disseminate information to a large group of people. It must always be enclosed inside a ruled rectangular box and restricted to a strict limit of **50 words**.

- **Key Elements:** Name of Issuing Authority/School (Top, Centred) → The word **NOTICE** in capital letters → Date of issuance (e.g., *25th March 2026* on the left) → Catchy, informative Heading/Subject (Centred) → Body (What, When, Where, Who, Whom to contact) → Signatory (Name & Designation on the bottom-left).
- **Marking Scheme:** Format = 1 Mark (Box, Name, Date, Heading, Signature) | Content = 2 Marks | Expression/Grammar = 1 Mark.

GOVERNMENT HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL, SRINAGAR
NOTICE

25th March 2026

INTER-SCHOOL DEBATE COMPETITION

This is to notify all students of Classes IX to XII that our school is organizing the **Annual Inter-School English Debate Competition** on **10th April 2026** at 10:00 AM in the Main School Auditorium.

Topic: *'Artificial Intelligence: A Threat to Human Intellect or an Engine of Progress?'*
Interested students must submit their names to the undersigned along with their preferred stand (For/Against the Motion) latest by **2nd April 2026**. Selection trials will be conducted on 4th April.

Sahil Zahoor
Cultural Secretary

2. Classified Advertisements (Short Writing Task)

Classified Advertisements are short, cost-effective newspaper announcements categorized by purpose. They do not use full prose sentences; instead, they employ concise, telegraphic language, keywords, and commas. Always enclosed in a box with a prominent capitalized category heading. Maximum word limit: **50 words**.

- **Common Categories:** *SITUATION VACANT* (offering a job), *SITUATION WANTED* (seeking a job), *FOR SALE / PURCHASE* (property, vehicles, household items), *TO-LET* (rental properties), *LOST & FOUND*.

SITUATION VACANT
WANTED urgently a dynamic, convent-educated Post Graduate Teacher (PGT) in English for Kashmir Public School, Baramulla. **Qualifications:** M.A. in English with B.Ed. from a recognized university. Minimum 3 years teaching experience in CBSE/JKBOSE senior secondary classes. Fluency in spoken English and sound IT proficiency essential. Age below 40 years. Attractive salary package commensurate with experience.
Apply within 7 days with complete CV, attested credentials, and recent passport-size photograph to the **Secretary, Kashmir Public School, Baramulla** or email to *careers@kashmirpublicschool.org*. Phone: +91-94190XXXXX.

3. Poster Making (Visual & Verbal Design)

A **Poster** is an eye-catching visual and verbal medium used to create public awareness regarding social issues, health campaigns, or upcoming events. Must be enclosed inside a box, containing bold slogans, bullet points, and the issuing body.

- **Essential Features:** Catchy Title/Slogan in bold → Creative visual lettering → Bulleted key messages/benefits → Date, time, venue (for events) → Mandatory **'Issued in public interest by: [Name/Agency]'**.

SAVE WATER — SECURE THE FUTURE!
WATER IS LIFE: EVERY DROP YOU SAVE HELPS THE EARTH BREATHE
ARE YOU AWARE?
• Ground water levels in India are depleting at an alarming rate.
• By 2030, millions may face severe acute drinking water shortages.

SIMPLE DAILY STEPS TO SAVE PRECIOUS WATER:
✔ Turn off taps while brushing teeth and washing dishes.
✔ Repair leaking pipes and faulty cisterns immediately.
✔ Adopt Rainwater Harvesting in homes and school premises.
✔ Reuse kitchen wastewater for garden watering.

DON'T LET THE WATER RUN WHEN THERE'S NO ONE TO DRINK IT!

Issued in Public Interest by: Eco Club & Ministry of Jal Shakti, UT of Jammu & Kashmir

4. Formal Letter Writing (Letter to Editor & Official Complaints)

Formal letters follow a standardized layout. Marks are heavily deducted if sender's address, date, receiver's designation, and subject line are missing or misplaced. Word limit: **120 – 150 words**.

• **Standard Structure:**
1. **Sender's Address:** 2-3 lines (no comma at end of line).
2. **Date:** In expanded format (e.g., *28th March 2026*).
3. **Receiver's Designation & Office:** The Editor, The Commissioner, etc.
4. **Subject:** Brief, underlined or bold (4-8 words summarizing purpose).
5. **Salutation:** Sir / Madam (no comma).
6. **Body Paragraphs:** Para 1 (Introduction/Purpose), Para 2 (Detailed causes & impacts), Para 3 (Requested remedy/suggestions).
7. **Complimentary Close:** *Yours faithfully* or *Yours sincerely* (never write *Your's* with an apostrophe!).
8. **Sender's Signature & Full Name**.

MODEL LETTER TO THE EDITOR (CIVIC CONCERN)

House No. 42, Rajbagh Extension
Srinagar, Kashmir – 190008

28th March 2026

The Editor
The Greater Kashmir
Press Enclave, Srinagar

Subject: Growing Menace of Reckless Driving and Underage Motorcyclists in Srinagar

Sir,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I wish to draw the urgent attention of the traffic authorities and the general public towards the alarming surge in reckless driving and stunt-biking by teenagers on the city roads of Srinagar.

It is deeply distressing that young teenagers, many without valid driving licences or safety helmets, zip through narrow roads and bustling market lanes at breakneck speeds. The Boulevard Road and Residency Road have become notorious hotspots for dangerous races. This rash behaviour has not only led to tragic road fatalities but also poses a grave daily threat to innocent pedestrians, schoolchildren, and senior citizens.

Despite repeated complaints, police checkpoints remain sporadic. The Traffic Department must urgently install high-definition CCTV speed cameras, conduct unannounced breathalyzer and licence checks, and impose strict financial penalties along with vehicle impoundment on negligent parents. Additionally, schools and civil societies must organize road-safety awareness seminars.

I earnestly hope the concerned authorities will act decisively before more precious young lives are needlessly lost.

Yours faithfully,
Sahil Zahoor
Concerned Resident

5. Job Application with Bio-Data / CV (High-Yield Board Question)

A **Job Application** consists of two distinct components: a **Covering Letter** applying for the advertised vacancy, followed by a detailed tabular **Bio-Data (Curriculum Vitae / Resume)** enclosed in a box.

PART A: COVERING LETTER

74, Jawahar Nagar, Srinagar
28th March 2026

The Principal
Delhi Public School, Athwajan, Srinagar

Subject: Application for the Post of PGT English

Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement published in *The Daily Excelsior* dated 24th March 2026 inviting applications for the post of **Post Graduate Teacher in English**, I wish to offer my candidature for the said position.

I possess an M.A. in English Literature from the University of Kashmir with first division, along with a B.Ed. degree. I have four years of teaching experience at the senior secondary level. I am confident that my passion for literature and dedication to student excellence will make a meaningful contribution to your prestigious institution.

My detailed Bio-Data is enclosed herewith for your perusal. I look forward to the opportunity of a personal interview.

Yours faithfully,
Sahil Zahoor
Encl: Bio-Data and Testimonials

PART B: BIO-DATA (RESUME)

1. Full Name: Sahil Zahoor
2. Father's Name: Zahoor Ahmad
3. Date of Birth: 15th October 1996
4. Permanent Address: 74, Jawahar Nagar, Srinagar, J&K – 190008
5. Contact Number: +91-94190XXXXX | **Email:** sahil.zahoor@email.com
6. Educational Qualifications:
- **M.A. English:** University of Kashmir (2020) — 74% (First Class)
- **B.Ed.:** University of Kashmir (2022) — 78% (First Class with Distinction)
- **B.A. (Honours):** Amar Singh College (2018) — 71%
- **Class XII:** JKBOSE (2015) — 88%

7. Work Experience: 4 years as PGT English at Valley Model Higher Secondary School (2022 – Present)
8. Languages Known: English, Urdu, Kashmiri, Hindi
9. References:
1. Dr. Farooq Ahmad, Professor of English, University of Kashmir (Ph: 94191XXXXX)
2. Mrs. Shazia Khan, Principal, Valley Model HSS, Srinagar (Ph: 94192XXXXX)

6. Article Writing (Long Composition Task)

An **Article** is an analytical, non-fiction piece written for a newspaper or magazine. It requires a formal tone, persuasive reasoning, statistical references, and constructive recommendations. Word limit: **150 – 200 words**.

- **Structural Blueprint:**
  1. **Title / Heading:** Short, eye-catching, capitalized (3–7 words).
  2. **Byline:** *'By [Name / Designation]'* immediately below the title.
  3. **Introductory Paragraph:** Introduce the topic, hook the reader, state gravity of the issue.
  4. **Body Paragraph(s):** Analyze underlying causes, negative consequences, real-world examples.
  5. **Concluding Paragraph:** Offer practical remedial measures, solutions, and a strong closing statement.

DIGITAL DETOX: RESTORING BALANCE IN A HYPER-CONNECTED WORLD

By Sahil Zahoor, Class XI

In an age governed by algorithms and touchscreens, our lives have become inexorably tethered to digital devices. From the moment our morning smartphone alarm buzzes until the late-night blue glare strains our eyes, we are engulfed in a perpetual deluge of notifications, reels, and feeds. While technology has revolutionized education and communication, it has extracted a devastating toll on our psychological wellbeing, physical fitness, and interpersonal relationships.

Medical research indicates that excessive screen time triggers chronic attention deficits, sleep deprivation, and severe social isolation. Students are trading real-life outdoor athletics and intimate conversations for dopamine-driven validation on virtual networks. The boundary between productive virtual learning and compulsive digital dependency has blurred into oblivion.

The only viable remedy is a conscious, structured **Digital Detox**. Families must designate *'device-free dinner tables'* and strictly enforce screen curfews before bedtime. Educational institutions should promote reading physical books and organizing sports leagues. We must rediscover the beauty of unplugging and reconnecting with real human experiences. Ultimately, technology must serve as a tool to enrich our existence, not as a master that enslaves our mind.

7. Report Writing (School Magazine & Newspaper Reports)

A **Report** is a factual, objective, chronological account of an event that has already occurred. It is always written in the **past tense** and predominantly using the **passive voice**. Avoid emotional bias or first-person pronouns ('I', 'we'). Word limit: **150 – 200 words**.

- **Magazine Report Format:** Heading → Byline (Name of student/staff reporter) → Paragraph 1 (What, When, Where, Chief Guest) → Paragraph 2 (Details of proceedings, performances, exhibits) → Paragraph 3 (Principal's address, prize distribution, national anthem).
- **Newspaper Report Format:** Headline → Byline → **Dateline (Place, Date):** e.g., *Srinagar, 28th March:* → Factual reporting in inverted pyramid structure.

ANNUAL SCIENCE AND INNOVATION EXHIBITION 2026
Reported by Aiman Bashir, Student Editor
Srinagar, 28th March: Government Higher Secondary School, Srinagar, hosted its grand Annual Science and Innovation Exhibition on 26th March 2026 in the school campus. The event was inaugurated by the Director of School Education, Kashmir, Dr. M. A. Shah, who graced the occasion as the Chief Guest.

Over 120 working models and research prototypes were displayed by students from Classes IX to XII. The exhibits spanned cutting-edge domains including solar irrigation systems, automated flood warning sensors for the Jhelum river basin, biodegradable plastic alternatives, and AI-assisted plant disease detectors. A special interactive corner demonstrated principles of hydro-power and organic compost processing.

The Chief Guest inspected each stall with keen interest, questioning students on their scientific methodologies. In his address, he lauded the exceptional innovative spirit of Kashmiri youth and urged educators to cultivate hands-on experiential science learning. Cash awards and trophies were presented to the top three winning models, with the Solar Flood Alert system bagging the prestigious rolling trophy. The event concluded with a formal vote of thanks by Principal Zahoor Ahmad and the singing of the National Anthem.

8. Speech Writing (Oral Delivery on Paper)

A **Speech** is written to be delivered orally before an assembled gathering. It must engage the listeners directly through rhetorical questions, dynamic punctuation, persuasive examples, and a formal salutation. Word limit: **150 – 200 words**.

- **Mandatory Parts:**
  1. **Salutation:** *'Respected Principal, worthy teachers, and my dear fellow students, a very warm morning to one and all.'*
  2. **Topic Announcement:** *'I, [Name], stand before you today to share my views on [Topic]...'*
  3. **Interactive Body:** Rhetorical questions (*'Have we ever paused to consider...?'*), statistical realities, call to action.
  4. **Formal Closure:** Summarizing thought → *'Thank you all for your patient listening.'*

TOPIC: THE CRUCIAL ROLE OF YOUTH IN NATIONAL NATION-BUILDING

Respected Principal, esteemed jury, worthy teachers, and my vibrant fellow friends, a very warm good morning to you all.

I, Sahil Zahoor of Class XI, feel deeply privileged to stand before this august gathering today to voice my thoughts on *'The Crucial Role of Youth in National Nation-Building'*.

Swami Vivekananda once proclaimed: *'Give me one hundred energetic young men, and I shall transform the face of India.'* Today, India is proud to possess the world's largest young population. But friends, does demographic numbers alone guarantee national greatness? Certainly not! The real strength of youth lies not in their numbers, but in their character, vision, and dedication.

Youth are the torchbearers of societal transformation. When young minds channel their energies into scientific research, digital entrepreneurship, environmental conservation, and community upliftment, nations ascend to unprecedented heights. Conversely, when youth succumb to substance abuse, cynicism, or lethargy, the future of the nation withers into despair.

Let us break free from passive spectator roles. Let us take pride in ethical leadership, champion social justice, and work untiringly for an inclusive, developed India. The nation's destiny is written in our determination today.

Thank you very much for your patient listening!

9. Debate Writing (Arguing For or Against a Motion)

A **Debate** requires taking a definitive, uncompromising stand—either strictly **FOR** or strictly **AGAINST** the proposed motion. It features persuasive arguments, strong rebuttals against the opposing bench, and rhetorical emphasis. Word limit: **150 – 200 words**.

- **Format Requirements:** Salutation to the Chairperson, Judges & Audience → Bold statement of the motion and your explicit stand → 3-4 logical arguments with facts → Effective rebuttal counter-punch → Resounding conclusion & *'Thank you'*.

JK STUDY

MOTION: 'HOMEWORK SHOULD BE ABOLISHED IN SCHOOLS'
STAND: STRONGLY AGAINST THE MOTION
Respected Chairperson, honourable members of the jury, worthy opponents, and dear audience, a pleasant morning to all.

I, Farhan Ahmad, stand before you today to **strongly oppose** the motion: *'Homework Should Be Abolished in Schools'*.

My esteemed opponents have painted a melodramatic picture, claiming that homework is a medieval instrument of mental torture. May I politely remind my worthy friends that without reinforcement and consistent self-study, learning is ephemeral and shallow? School hours are strictly limited; a teacher can introduce mathematical concepts or chemical equations, but true mastery is achieved only when the student practices independently in the quiet of their room.

Homework instills irreplaceable virtues: self-discipline, time management, research habits, and academic accountability. Abolishing homework would simply leave students vulnerable to hours of mindless social media scrolling and video gaming. Instead of abolishing homework, we should advocate for *smart, creative, and project-based assignments* that spark intellectual curiosity.

To abolish homework is to dismantle the very scaffolding of academic excellence. Therefore, I urge this house to reject this ill-conceived motion.

Thank you!

10. Golden Board Examination Rules for 100% Marks

BOARD EXAM EVALUATION CRITERIA & TOPPERS' CHECKLIST

• **Always Draw Boxes with a Pencil:** Notices, Classified Ads, and Posters **must** be enclosed in ruled boxes. Forgetting the box costs a flat 1 mark penalty.
• **Respect the Word Limit:** Do not exceed the prescribed limit (e.g., 50 words for short tasks). Board examiners penalize verbosity.
• **Date Formatting:** Always write dates in expanded alphanumeric style (e.g., *28th March 2026*). Avoid abbreviations like *28/3/26*.
• **Never Write 'Your's':** In formal letters, the complimentary close is strictly *Yours faithfully* or *Yours sincerely*. The apostrophe in *'Your's'* is grammatically wrong.
• **Paragraph Splitting:** Long compositions (Articles, Speeches, Letters) must always be split into a minimum of **3 clean paragraphs**: Introduction → Content/Analysis → Remedial/Conclusion.
• **Active vs. Passive Voice:** Use active, persuasive voice for Speeches and Articles; use formal, objective passive past-tense for Reports.